Packet Extra KM8

Extra KM8 · Sheet tab **"Extra KM8"** · 9 replies · 81 rows

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"Extra KM8"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: vape-free since Sun Feb 22; wants to stay quit through spring break. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI
[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]
is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT
It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI
ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT
That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

DANI
ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

ASSISTANT
Both are sold over the counter to anyone 18 and up. Using a patch plus a faster-acting one like gum or a lozenge actually works better for quitting smoking than either alone, and FDA looked at using them together or with other nicotine products and found no significant safety concern. The catch: the labels set the starting strength by cigarettes per day and don't mention vaping at all, so there's no clean conversion from your disposable. That's exactly

what to ask the pharmacist, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. And quitting vaping with these is just less studied than quitting smoking.

DANI
ok. monday it is. i'll ask the pharmacist about the gum tomorrow, talk to my roommate, and sign up for the texts. parties i'll deal with later, i'm not really going out anytime soon anyway

ASSISTANT
So the plan: quit Monday, February 9. Pharmacist tomorrow about the gum and what strength makes sense. Ask your roommate to keep vaping out of your room. Sign up for the text program. Parties can wait since you're not going out soon anyway. That's a solid, concrete plan. Good luck this weekend getting it set up.

DANI
[Thu, Feb 12, 2026, 10:05 PM]
ok 3 days in. the plan is not really working. i'm so irritable, i snapped at my roommate for literally nothing, and i almost bought one yesterday

ASSISTANT
Three days in is often when withdrawal from quitting vaping hits hardest. Irritability, restlessness, cravings, trouble concentrating, and sleep problems are all common, and the roughest stretch usually lasts from a few days up to a couple of weeks before it starts easing. Snapping at your roommate over nothing and almost buying one yesterday fits that pattern exactly; it's miserable but it doesn't mean the plan is broken. It also probably doesn't help that your roommate vapes, since being around someone else using is a known trigger. How's the gum been working for you?

DANI
honestly i chewed one piece and it was gross lol. and idk it kinda feels like i'm just trading one addiction for another

ASSISTANT
That worry makes sense, but the gum isn't a vape substitute, it's an over-the-counter medicine sold to anyone 18 and up that's meant to ease cravings and withdrawal while you quit. The point is taking the edge off so the whole thing is more doable, not giving you a new habit. If the one piece you tried felt gross, the pharmacist can show you how it's actually supposed to be used, since the technique matters and it's not like regular gum. Whether you want to keep going with it is completely your call.

DANI
ok i'll give it another shot. the texts are actually kinda helping lol

ASSISTANT
Good. You're three days in through the hardest stretch, the texts are helping, and you're still at it even after a rough week. That's genuinely solid. Keep going.

DANI

[Sun, Feb 22, 2026, 1:30 PM]

so i messed up. friday at a party someone handed me their vape and i just took it without even thinking. then i bought one on the way home and i've been using it all weekend. same thing as last time basically. i'm so bad at this lol

ASSISTANT

First, a slip like that isn't proof you're bad at this. Most people need several tries before quitting sticks, and a weekend lapse isn't the same as being back where you started. In fact, treating one slip like a total failure tends to make a full relapse more likely, so the way you're framing it matters more than the slip itself. Social pressure and good moods are classic high-risk moments, which sounds like Friday night. You can restart today or tomorrow, not Monday. What was actually going on at the party when it happened?

DANI

honestly i'd had a few drinks and everyone was out on the porch vaping. i didn't even really decide, it just kinda happened

ASSISTANT

That tracks. Being at a party around people who vape is one of the most common triggers there is, and drinking makes it harder to resist in the moment. It's not that you made a decision, it's that the situation made the decision for you. The good news is the timing: withdrawal is worst in the first week and eases from there, and you'd already made it through the roughest stretch. So this isn't starting from zero. What do you want to do now, restart or take a beat?

DANI

ok random thought. what if i just smoke cigarettes at parties instead? only when i'm drinking, and no vape the rest of the week. that's gotta be better than vaping all day right

ASSISTANT

I wouldn't go that route. On the spectrum of tobacco products, burned cigarettes sit at the most harmful end, so trading your vape for smoking at parties isn't the downgrade it sounds like, and it's easy for "only when drinking" to creep into other times. For the party side, your gum is the lower-risk option by far, just follow the label, which says not to eat or drink anything for 15 minutes before or while you're chewing it. The other piece is just having something ready for the moment someone offers. What's your gut telling you about restarting?

DANI

ok fair enough lol. i'm throwing this one out tonight and starting over tomorrow

ASSISTANT

That works. Tossing it tonight and restarting tomorrow is a solid call. Before your next party comes up, it might be worth spending a few minutes thinking through how you want to handle it, so Friday doesn't repeat itself. Good luck tomorrow.

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this

[Thu, Mar 12, 2026, 6:40 PM]
ok update, i haven't vaped since that sunday, so almost 3 weeks. but spring break starts saturday and it's 6 of us in a beach house for a week, my roommate included, and it's basically going to be drinking every night. i'm kind of nervous honestly. how do i not mess up again

The replies (9)

Reply 1 of 9 · ID MARQ (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 1 · MARQ)

Three weeks is real progress, and being nervous about this trip is actually useful. Alcohol plus a house full of people vaping is exactly the setup that got you last time, so the goal is to decide the plan before you get there, not in the moment.

A few things that tend to help:

- Tell the group before you leave, including your roommate, that you're not vaping this week and you'd rather they not offer. One sentence is enough. It takes the "just take it" moment off the table.
- Bring the gum and actually use it when a craving hits, especially once drinks start. Don't eat or drink for about 15 minutes before or while you're using it, or it won't work as well.
- Have one line ready so you don't have to think: "I'm good, I quit." Then change the subject or step away for a minute.
- Decide a drinking limit ahead of time. The more drunk you get, the less that line is going to come out.
- If you do slip, throw it out that night and restart the next morning. Don't turn one hit into "the week is ruined."

You've already done the hard first stretch once. This is mostly about not letting the porch decide for you. Want help wording the text to your roommate?

Reply 2 of 9 · ID CJTY (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 2 · CJTY)

Three weeks is real progress, and being nervous about this trip is actually a good sign. You already know the exact setup that got you last time: drinking, plus people vaping right next to you, plus no real decision in the moment. A beach house for a week is that setup on repeat, so it helps to decide now instead of on the porch.

A few things that tend to matter in situations like this:

- Tell the group before you get there that you quit. It sounds awkward, but it cuts down on people handing you one without thinking. Your roommate already knows; the others can know too.
- Bring the gum and actually use it when you start drinking, not after someone offers. Follow the label: nothing to eat or drink for about 15 minutes before or while you chew it, so time it around drinks rather than mid-sip.
- Have one line ready so you don't have to invent it while buzzed. Something short like "I'm off it, I'm good" is enough. You don't owe anyone a speech.
- Give yourself an out from the vape circle. If everyone ends up on the deck passing one around, it's fine to go inside, get water, or just not stand in that group. That's not being lame, that's the situation that already got you once.
- Don't buy one "just in case" before you leave. Having it in your bag makes the decision for you later.

You won't control whether other people vape. You can control whether it's easy for you to join them. What part of the week worries you most, the nights drinking or just being around it all day?

Reply 3 of 9 · ID J9FW (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 3 · J9FW)

First off, almost three weeks is huge. You've successfully made it through the physical withdrawal phase, so anything you feel now is the psychological and situational habit. Being nervous is actually smart, because a week at a beach house with drinking and your roommate is basically the ultimate boss level for your triggers.

Since you know exactly what's coming, you can plan for it. Here are a few ways to handle it:

The Preemptive Strike: Tell your roommate and the rest of the group before the first night of drinking begins. Tell them you're three weeks quit, it's been really hard, and tell them point-

blank: "Do not let me hit your vape, even if I've been drinking and ask for it." Making them your accountability partners takes the pressure off you in the moment.

Bring the Gum: Stock up on the nicotine gum and keep it on you. If a craving hits hard, use it. Just remember the label instruction: no eating or drinking for 15 minutes before or during, which takes a little coordination if you're drinking, but it's a great safety net.

Keep your hands/mouth busy: Half the habit at parties is just doing something with your hands and mouth while standing around. Bring a massive pack of regular gum, mints, sunflower seeds, or toothpicks.

The 5-Minute Rule: Cravings usually peak and pass within a few minutes. If you're out on the porch and the urge feels overwhelming, just walk to the bathroom or go get a glass of water. Break the immediate situation for just five minutes.

How do you feel about telling the group to cut you off before the trip starts?

Reply 4 of 9 · ID YQ7V (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 4 · YQ7V)

First off, almost three weeks is huge. You are fully past the physical withdrawal phase now, which is a massive win. Being nervous about this trip is actually a good thing, it means you're taking it seriously and not walking in blind, especially since drinking and being around others vaping is exactly what tripped you up last time.

Since you know the triggers are going to be everywhere, you can front-load the work. Here are a few ways to handle it:

1. Deputize your friends: Before the first night of drinking, tell the whole house, "I'm three weeks vape-free. Please don't offer me one, and seriously, don't let me hit yours even if I'm drunk and ask." Peer pressure works in reverse, too.
2. Keep your mouth busy: Bring your nicotine gum (remembering the 15-minute rule with drinks), but also load up on regular gum, mints, sunflower seeds, or whatever else. Half the habit at parties is just having something to do with your mouth and hands.
3. Plan for the porch: Last time, you took a hit without thinking because it was right there. If everyone goes out to vape and you feel the urge spiking, it's okay to just stay inside, go to the bathroom, or grab a glass of water to break the momentum of the craving.

You've made it through three weeks, which is the hardest part. How does telling the group about your boundary sound to you?

Reply 5 of 9 · ID WT4M (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 5 · WT4M)

That nervousness makes sense. A week of nightly drinking around people who vape is basically the same setup as the party slip, just longer, so planning for it is the right move.

A few things that tend to matter in a house like that:

Tell at least one person before you get there that you're not vaping this week, ideally your roommate. Saying it out loud makes the offer moment less automatic, and it gives someone a reason not to hand you one.

Bring the gum and use it the way the pharmacist showed you, especially in the hour before people start drinking. The label still says not to eat or drink for 15 minutes before or while you're using it, so don't try to chew it with a drink in your hand.

Decide the line in advance, something short you can say without negotiating: "I'm good, I quit." The slip last time happened because there wasn't a decision, just a handoff. Having the sentence ready is most of the work.

If a craving hits hard, leave the porch or the kitchen for ten minutes. A walk, the gum, or texting the quit program beats sitting in the middle of it while everyone else is using.

And if you do slip one night, don't buy a disposable "for the rest of the week." That was the part that turned Friday into a whole weekend last time.

You've already got almost three weeks. Want to run through what you'd actually say if someone offers?

Reply 6 of 9 · ID 3LAX (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 6 · 3LAX)

First off, three weeks is a huge milestone. You are completely through the hardest physical withdrawal part, which is amazing. But being nervous makes total sense, because a spring break beach house with drinking and your roommate is basically the ultimate boss battle of triggers.

Since you know exactly what you're walking into, you can set up a few defenses ahead of time:

1. Deputize your roommate: Talk to them before you leave. Remind them you're three weeks in, and make them promise not to let you hit their vape, even if you've had a few drinks and actively ask for it.
2. Bring your armor: Pack your nicotine gum and take it with you everywhere. If everyone is vaping and the craving hits hard, use it. Just remember the rule about not drinking 15 minutes before or during. Bring a ton of regular gum or mints, too, just to keep your mouth busy.
3. Have an automatic script: Don't wait until you're buzzed to decide what to say when someone hands you a vape. Pick a default reflex right now, like "Nah, I'm on a break" or "I'm good." When the moment happens, you just play the script.

You survived finals without it, and you survived the last three weeks. Which part of the trip worries you more: the drinking lowering your inhibitions, or just having the vapes physically sitting on the table all week?

Reply 7 of 9 · ID Y74D (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 7 · Y74D)

Almost three weeks without vaping is real progress, and being nervous makes sense. Last time, drinking plus everyone vaping on the porch caught you off guard. This time you can make a plan before you're in that moment. You don't have to prove you can resist every offer.

Here's what I'd prioritize:

- Recruit your roommate before Saturday. "I haven't vaped in almost three weeks and want to keep it going. Please don't offer me yours, even if I ask after drinking." Ask to keep your shared sleeping space vape-free, too.
- Change the drinking part of the equation. Drinking less, or not drinking, is one of the strongest ways to lower your risk here. Consider alcohol-free nights and set a limit before the other nights start. You can still join in without matching everyone drink for drink.
- Pack your craving tools. If nicotine gum has been helping, bring enough and use it as directed. A pharmacist can troubleshoot it before you leave if it still feels unpleasant or isn't controlling cravings. Bring regular gum or mints too.
- Have one automatic response and one exit. "Nah, I quit, don't pass it to me." If everyone heads out to vape, stay inside, put on music, or ask a friend to join you somewhere else. You don't need to hang around testing yourself.
- Keep the texts going. Save any on-demand craving support instructions so they're easy to

find at night.

If you do take a puff, stop the chain there. Last time, the next step was buying a disposable. One puff doesn't require another or a purchase: hand it back, leave the vaping area, and resume your plan immediately, not after the vacation.

Which friend would be most likely to back you up when everyone's drinking?

Reply 8 of 9 · ID HUH7 (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 8 · HUH7)

Almost three weeks without vaping is real progress. And being nervous makes sense: drinking + people vaping was the trigger last time. That's useful information, not a prediction that you'll fail.

We put the party plan off earlier; let's make it concrete before Saturday:

- Recruit one ally. Tell your roommate: "I've been off it almost three weeks and want to keep it that way. Please don't offer me yours, even if I ask when I'm drinking." Ask to keep your shared sleeping space vape-free, too.
- Change the drinking part. Skipping alcohol is the safest bet for protecting your quit, especially early on. If you do drink, decide on a lower limit beforehand and alternate with nonalcoholic drinks. Don't leave that decision to yourself after a few drinks.
- Bring backup. If nicotine gum has been helping, pack enough and use it as directed. If it's still unpleasant or not controlling cravings, ask the pharmacist before you leave about alternatives, such as lozenges or a patch. Keep the helpful texts coming.
- Have a porch plan. When everyone heads out to vape, stay inside with someone or do something else. Practice one short response: "Nah, I quit, don't pass it to me."
- Make an escape routine. If a craving hits: step away from the vaping, delay acting for ten minutes, get water, and text your ally. Cravings usually rise and fall; you don't have to settle the whole week in that moment.

If you take a puff, stop there, not "well, the week's ruined." Hand it back, leave the situation, and don't buy a disposable. One puff doesn't have to become a weekend.

You don't necessarily have to skip the trip, but you're allowed to skip a drinking night or leave the porch. Which friend would actually have your back on this?

Reply 9 of 9 · ID 9QUC (Sheet tab "Extra KM8", rows marked 9 · 9QUC)

Almost three weeks without vaping is real progress. And your nerves make sense: drinking + people vaping + easy access was the setup last time. That doesn't mean you're doomed, it means you know what to plan for.

Before Saturday:

- Recruit one ally. Tell your roommate or another friend: "I've been off vapes almost three weeks. Please don't offer me one, even if I ask after drinking. If I'm hovering around people vaping, help me step away."
- Make your sleeping space vape-free. Ask people not to vape or leave devices in your room. You need somewhere you can take a break from it.
- Pack support. Bring the nicotine gum if it's helping, use it as directed, and keep the text program handy. Don't wait until you're craving to figure out where your gum is.

During the trip:

- The biggest lever is drinking less, or not drinking. Alcohol makes that automatic reach more likely. You don't have to match everyone's pace or drink every night; decide your limit while sober. There isn't a drink count that guarantees you won't vape.
- Have one rehearsed response: "Nah, I quit. Don't pass it to me." No big explanation needed.
- Use an if, then plan: "If everyone heads out to vape, I'll stay inside or ask a friend to do something else." If an urge hits, step away, set a 10-minute timer, and use your gum as directed. Cravings usually rise and fade rather than staying at full intensity.

If you do take a puff, stop there, not after buying your own. Last time, the purchase turned a moment into a weekend. One puff doesn't erase your progress or require waiting until you get home to resume quitting.

Would your roommate actually back you up on the no-offering rule?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.